

44% IN BANGALORE FIND WIVES LESS ATTRACTIVE AFTER CHILDBIRTH

Do you get enough time alone to spend with your spouse in a joint family?



All figures in per cent. Rest: Don't know/Won't say.

How do you revitalise your sex life?

		MALE	FEMALE
Go out on a weekend	35	34	37
Infuse more romance	33	34	32
Talk to spouse about what he/she needs from sex life	28	24	32
Try doing different things together, like sports	14	19	9
Go to a counsellor	4	4	3

All figures in per cent. Figures add up to more than 100 because of multiple choices.

After how many years of marriage did you have your first child?

		MALE	FEMALE
One year	49	45	52
Two years	31	35	28
Three years	13	14	12
Four-five years	4	3	4
More than five years	3	3	3

All figures in per cent. Rest: Don't know/Won't say.

Does living in a joint family affect your sex life? If so, how?

		MALE	FEMALE
Does not affect the number of times you have sex	47	41	54
Reduces the frequency of sex	32	34	29
Increases the frequency of sex	11	14	7

All figures in per cent. Rest: Don't know/Won't say.

THE BIG DESCENT

Loss is inscribed in the first cry of erotic love. Once back home, couples are made to buckle down to the institution of marriage. Almost half say they had their first child in the first year of marriage.

one: how we view ourselves, and, profoundly, what is our understanding of the nature of sexual passion. A degree of ordinariness creeps up on us as we move away in time from the intimacy of lovemaking, from its dark and sparkling terrain. Honey-mooners experience this even as they discover the textures of pleasure. With

tarily frees each one from all the rules, all at once. For, in a sense we create Time by freezing it while making love, we destroy Space for we contain it in our bodies during lovemaking. Thus, we preserve ourselves in an everlasting present—for the few moments of climax.

Beyond discovery and play, beyond intensity and



the birth of erotic love come some of its withdrawal symptoms; loss is inscribed into its first cry.

Once back home, we are made to buckle down to the institutionalised relationship of marriage. We have to morph into everyday beings. Saddened, we descend from dense clouds of desire to fall into the gridlock of routine. We need to adapt and accept changes while our inner and outer geographies of identity are in dislocation.

Yet, most of all, it is erotic love itself that dislocates us, enlarges us, withers us. We know sexual passion momen-

thankfulness, beyond the body's pleasures that are set aflame, then soothed into the quietest water, lovemaking performs these miracles each time. It's hardly surprising that we are enchanted by it; it's therefore also hardly surprising that loss inevitably follows. Between dreams and reality lies not a connecting space but a void. This void or zone needs to be filled. It often is, with losses of many colours and shapes, rather than the scents of discovery and joy that are equally present.

We also attempt to fill the void with the prospect of chil-